

A Few Bits of Advice

Mundane Sources of Power: This is a campaign with a globe-spanning scope and hundreds of characters. You might be an epic hero or just a world-class sonofabitch, but you will be shaping the fate of global organizations by the time you're through. So, although you might wield magic or come into contact with magical creatures or powerful magical artifacts, most of the real power in Faerun is non-magical. Outside of Thay, magic is not prevalent enough to form the basis of sustained or widespread power. The most dangerous creature in my version of Faerun is a person with power; political, economic, or military, the folks with the power are far more likely to get you killed than the monsters in the forest.

Don't Always Fight: This campaign takes place in an empire of laws and order. There are often situations where any kind of combat is wildly outside of the expected norms. Kill someone in the streets of Melvaunt and, if there are witnesses, you will be detained and possibly executed for murder. Even in cases where combat is more appropriate, running away from combat should always be considered a viable option, especially given how little magical healing is available. Surrender is also an option, but sometimes it's less viable than others. Consequences are real. This is not quite George R.R. Martin, but it's also not a Disney fairy tale.

Knowledge Good, Meta-Knowledge Bad: Assume all of your meta-knowledge is wrong. And don't assume you or your PC know the ins and outs of kobolds or owlbears just because you've read the Monster Manual. Creatures in my version of Forgotten Realms don't always follow the rules. The same is true for Forgotten Realms history.

Questing for Knowledge & Skills: More so than other campaigns, knowledge is a vital component for success. Many of your campaign goals and XP rewards will come from acquiring general knowledge, skills or information about a specific person or organization. So, there might also be campaign goal methods for earning new skills and proficiencies not listed in the rulebooks.

Sometimes, Dead's Better: The Moonsea Empire has forged an uneasy alliance with the the nation of Thay and Zsass Tam, the lich necromancer who rules it. But because of deep-seated suspicions of Thay and due to the violent history of the Moonsea Empire and the Zhentarim, resurrection magic is outlawed. Anyone proven to have used such magic to come back from death forfeits his or her rights and titles and may be killed on sight.

Even more troubling, it is generally believed that those who come back from the dead are much more susceptible to evil influence. You may not come back the same as you were before you died. Just a warning.